BRACKENFORD WATER FORUM 2026

Programme: Day One

Thursday 14 May 2026 · Brackenford Exchange Centre

The forum brings together utilities, regulators and community groups to discuss how river catchments can be managed for both people and wildlife. Sessions in Hall A focus on policy and finance, while Hall B hosts practical case studies.

Schedule

Time	Hall A: Policy and finance	Hall B: Case studies
08:30	**Registration and coffee**	
09:15	**Opening keynote: Rivers as shared infrastructure**	
10:15	Paying for catchment restoration: lessons from three funding models	Rebuilding the Ashby meanders: five years on
11:15	Regulating diffuse pollution	Farmers as water managers
12:30	**Lunch and poster exhibition**	
13:45	Panel: who owns the flood risk?	Citizen monitoring networks
15:00	Water pricing and fairness	Urban rivers and new housing
16:15	**Closing keynote and reception**	

Keynote speakers

Dr Helena Marsh

Helena leads the catchment science group at the Brackenford Environment Trust. Her talk opens the forum with a view of rivers as infrastructure that serves every sector.

Samuel Okonjo

Samuel chairs the regional farmers network and has converted his own land to wetland grazing. He will speak about the costs and rewards of changing farm practice.

Prof. Ana Lindqvist

Ana studies public finance and has advised several water regulators. Her closing keynote asks who should pay for a healthy river.

Practical information

- Badges must be worn at all times inside the centre.
- Wireless access is available in both halls and in the exhibition area.
- Slides from each session will be shared with registered delegates after the forum.